Tech Scout — 16 Oct 2026

SHOOT DAY 26 OCT 2026 · TWO SETS · DIRECTOR, DP, GAFFER, KEY GRIP, CAM OP, 1st AD, VIDEO ASSIST

LOCKED — PLEASE DON'T RE-OPEN THESE ON SITE

Pad	202.8 × 81.0 ft. Measured off the Google Maps scale bar, corroborated by the slab's 2.4:1 aspect.
Orientation	**Page up on the plate is 332° true (NNW), not north.** Cameras look NNW. Measured two ways, agree within 1.5°.
Sun, 26 Oct	Rise 06:23 · solar noon 12:09 at 59.0° · set 17:56 AST. Azimuth verified to 0.005°.
Key direction	Sun is **camera left all afternoon** (−101° at 14:30 → −77° at 17:30). Never flips, so both sets cut together.
Cam A throw	35 mm full frame needs **35 ft** to cover the band. On Super 35 the same frame needs ~48 ft, which is into the road.
Light level	Only −0.44 stops from 14:30 to 16:30. Then −0.81 by 17:00 and −1.77 by 17:30.

DP RECOMMENDATIONS I'M BRINGING TO THE SCOUT

1 · No 20×20. At 14:30 a four-hi-roller rig covers 13.2 ft; the compressed band needs 13.5. Short by inches, and it is 400 sq ft of sail on an open pad in October trades for one hour of coverage. The geometry only closes with a 24.6 ft top rail raked 30° — that's a condor, not a grip stand.
Instead: shoot the natural side light; 12×12 ultrabounce camera right to pull the ratio from ~8:1 to 3–4:1; 12×12 diffusion reserved for Cam B / C close-ups, where one person at a time is trivially covered.

2 · Swap the running order. The band is the wide subject and needs the low sun; the duo is narrow and doesn't. As scheduled it's inverted. Band at 16:30 removes the diffusion problem entirely. **Cost: band loads out at dusk.** AD's call.

WHAT WE MUST WALK OUT KNOWING

#	DEPT	QUESTION	WHY IT MATTERS
1	Gaffer / AD	**Where does power come from?** Panel at the park, the shelter, or a genny?	Band rider alone is ~2–4 kW of audio before a single light. Two dedicated 20 A circuits minimum.
2	Gaffer / DP	Stand at the band position and look **west** — how high is the treeline, how far?	Trees west/NW will shadow the pad at 12–25° sun. The real out-time, not 17:56.
3	Key Grip	Wind at the band position. Feel it at both set times.	Decides whether any frame flies at all. This is the gating item, not the geometry.
4	Key Grip	Can we get stands and sandbags onto the pad? Where's the ballast coming from?	Load path and the curb lip at the pad edge.
5	Cam Op	Is there **35 ft of clear, level ground** south of the pad for Cam A?	The whole 35 mm wide depends on it. Check for the curb, road and parked cars.
6	Cam Op / VA	Cable run distances from A, B and C back to village.	Video assist spec and cable order.
7	VA / AD	Where is video village? Needs shade and power.	No shade anywhere near the camera positions.
8	1st AD	Can the running order swap (band late, duo early)? Band load-in / out path and times, park access, permits, other users, lock-up.	See recommendation 2. If we swap, the band strikes at dusk and needs work lights.
9	DP / Dir	**Stake both footprints with the real backline.** Band ≤ 14 ft? Duo ≤ 12 ft?	Every lighting number downstream assumes them. 4.5 ft per player across the band's front line.

TIMING ON SITE TODAY — TODAY'S LIGHT RUNS ~15 MIN AHEAD OF SHOOT DAY

14:15 today	= shoot-day 14:30. Sun 43.5°, camera left.
15:15 today	= shoot-day 15:30. Sun 31.6°, clean 90° side.
16:15 today	= shoot-day 16:30. Sun 18.7°, raking.
16:50 today	= shoot-day 17:00. **Treeline check.**

Bring / do:

- Tape measure — stake the 14 ft band box and the Cam A position
- Meter the key-to-shadow ratio at 14:15 and 16:15
- Reference stills at both times, same lens, for the director
- Photograph the western treeline from the band position
- Find the power tie-in or confirm we're on a genny

Grip & Gaffer Package

FOR SCOUT DISCUSSION · REV 1, 16 OCT 2026

> **The number that drives this list.** At 14:30 the sun delivers about **8,700 fc**. A 1.2k HMI through a 6×6 at 6 ft delivers about **167 fc** — **5.7 stops under**. No unit in a 1-ton package keys against that sun. So for Set 1 the sun *is* the key and we shape it with bounce; the 1.2k's real job is Set 2, after the sun leaves. Levels are order-of-magnitude from luminous flux and inverse square — check against the head's own photometric chart.

DESIGN INTENT

SET 1 · BAND · hard side sun	**Key = the sun**, camera left, 43.5°→31.6°. It is the only source even across 14 ft. Fill the shadow side with bounce to ~4:1. Put a low bounce under the frame line to get light into eyes under the cap brims — that is the real problem at 43°, not the ratio.
SET 2 · DUO · sun leaving	**16:30–17:00 natural** — raking key camera left at 18.7°→12°, bounce right for fill. This is the best light of the day; front-load hero coverage. **17:00–17:15 crossover. 17:15 on: 1.2k through 6×6**, camera left at the sun's departing angle so the key direction does not change on the cut. Backlight for separation once the sky goes flat.

GRIP

QTY	ITEM	PURPOSE
2	**8×8 frame + ultrabounce**	Set 1 fill, camera right, just outside the frustum, in full sun. Two 8×8s beat one 12×12 here — half the sail each and they cover the 14 ft width evenly.
1	**12×12 frame + ultrabounce**	Set 2 fill. Can be struck and re-skinned for the key at crossover.
1	**6×6 frame + 1/4 grid**	Set 2 key diffusion for the 1.2k. Small frame on purpose — it gets close, and proximity is what buys the level.
1	**4×4 ultrabounce + turtle base**	**Eye light.** Low and centred, just under frame. Kills the cap-brim shadow. Cheapest fix on the list.
2	**4×4 floppy**	Flare control. Sun is a 90° side all afternoon — lens flare is a live risk on the camera-left side of every setup.
4	**Hi-roller stands**	Frames. No 20×20 — see the scout brief.
6	**Combo stands**	Frames, heads.
8	**C-stands + arms**	Flags, floppies, the 4×4.
40	**Sandbags**	**Minimum.** Open concrete pad, October trades, nothing to tie to. This is the number I will not negotiate down.
—	**Ratchet straps / tie-downs**	Frames. Bags alone are not enough if it gusts.
—	**Apple boxes, wedges, cribbing**	Pad edges are not level; stands need levelling at the curb lip.
—	**Carpet / neg fill**	**Targeted, not blanket.** Lay it where concrete bounce reads in frame and in the background. Do *not* carpet under the band at 43° sun — that uplight is what is saving the eyes.

ELECTRIC

QTY	ITEM	PURPOSE
1	**1.2k HMI + ballast + head cable**	**Have it.** Set 2 key from ~17:15. Not a Set 1 unit.
1	**Second head — 1.2k or 600 W LED COB (ASK)**	Backlight / separation for the duo once the sky flattens. This is what makes Set 2 look built rather than merely exposed. Biggest single upgrade to the package.
—	**Gel: 1/4 + 1/2 CTO, 1/4 CTB, ND3 / ND6**	The sun warms hard as it drops. The HMI has to chase it or the cut will not match.
—	**Stingers, 100 ft runs, distro**	Camera positions are ~28 ft off the pad; village further.
2	**Work lights / balloon**	Band load-out at dusk if the running order swaps.

POWER

LOAD	W	A
1.2k HMI + ballast	**1400**	**14**
Second head	**1400**	**14**
Band audio — ESTIMATE	**2500**	**25**
Village, monitors, chargers	**500**	**5**
TOTAL	**5800**	**58**

Paper amps at 120 V (W/100). Band figure is my estimate from the rider and must be confirmed by sound.

> **10–12 kW tow plant.** 5.8 kW running, but HMI ballasts surge to roughly 2× at strike — size for the strike, not the run. Never run a plant continuously under 20% of capacity.
>
> **Keep the HMI off the audio supply.** Ballast noise into a PA is a classic and it will not be fixable in post. Separate putt-putt for sound, or separate legs at minimum, and sound gets the say.

OPEN: band audio draw · whether a second head is in budget · generator vs. park service · confirmed band and duo footprints.

Coverage Lighting — Day Exterior

REV 1, 16 OCT 2026 · SUN IS CAMERA LEFT ALL AFTERNOON

> **The method: subtract first, then your small sources matter.** Nothing in the package out-guns an 8,700 fc sun. But cut the subject out of it with a solid and the ambient drops to roughly 800–1,500 fc — at which point an 8×8 bounce at 1,286 fc is the *dominant* key. You are not fighting the sun, you are removing it and replacing it with a key you chose the angle of.
>
> **Why this works on coverage and not on the wide:** an overhead flown at 9 ft is in shot at 85 mm and clears frame from 135 mm up. The long lens hides the rig. That is the whole reason the tight pass is lightable and the 35 mm wide is not.

WHAT EACH SOURCE ACTUALLY DELIVERS — 14:30 SUN = 8,735 FC

4×4 hard silver @ 15 ft	**3,538 fc**	**−1.3 st**	4×4 ultrabounce @ 5 ft	**1,286 fc**	**−2.8 st**
12×12 ultrabounce @ 12 ft	**1,835 fc**	**−2.3 st**	4×4 ultrabounce @ 10 ft	**368 fc**	**−4.6 st**
8×8 ultrabounce @ 10 ft	**1,286 fc**	**−2.8 st**	1.2k HMI thru 6×6 @ 6 ft	**167 fc**	**−5.7 st**

Hard silver is the only thing that competes, because it is re-aiming the sun. The HMI is four stops behind it — which is why it is a Set 2 unit, not a Set 1 unit.

SET 1 · BAND · 14:30–15:30 · SUN 43.5°→31.6°, CAMERA LEFT

SETUP	USE IT FOR	BUILD
WIDE	Cam A, 35 mm. Not lightable.	**Schedule it, don't light it.** Shoot 15:20–15:30 when the sun is lowest and squarest. 2× 8×8 ultrabounce camera right for fill; 4×4 ultrabounce low and centred for eyes. Then move on — this is 15 seconds of the video.
A · CUT & BOUNCE	Vocalist, faces. The workhorse.	**6×6 solid overhead** at 9 ft, 9.5 ft up-sun → subject out of direct sun. **8×8 ultrabounce camera left @ 10 ft** = key, now dominant over ambient. **4×4 neg camera right** sets the ratio. A 43° toplight becomes a ~30° soft side key you chose. Nothing bigger than an 8×8 in the air.
B · NATURAL + SUBTRACT	Volume coverage. 5-minute build.	No overhead. Sun stays the 90° side key. **4×4 ultrabounce low @ 5 ft** = eye light at −2.8 stops, which is exactly right to open the cap-brim shadow. **4×4 floppy** sider for flare. **4×4 neg camera right** to deepen the shadow side. Fast, repeatable, gets you shots per hour.
C · SHINY BOARD	Guitar, hands, strings, chrome.	**6×6 solid overhead** to cut, then **4×4 hard silver low camera left @ 15 ft** — 3,538 fc, only 1.3 stops under sun. Turns a 43° toplight into a 15–20° raking key with real punch on an instrument. **Do not put this in a singer's eyes.** Details only.

SET 2 · DUO · 16:30–17:30 · SUN 18.7°→5.3°, CAMERA LEFT

SETUP	WINDOW	BUILD
D · RIDE THE SUN	16:30–17:00 Best light of the day.	The sun *is* the key, raking camera left at 18.7°→12°. Don't touch it. **12×12 ultrabounce camera right** at −2.3 stops → clean 3:1. **4×4 neg** instead if you want it moodier. **Front-load the hero coverage into this half-hour.**
E · BUILT KEY	17:00 onward After the sun goes.	**1.2k through 6×6 @ 6 ft, camera left**, placed at the sun's departing azimuth (249°→255°) so the key direction does not jump on the cut. **Second head as a 3/4 backlight**, camera right-rear — this is what makes it look built rather than merely exposed. Gel 1/4 CTO at 17:00, 1/2 CTO by 17:30, chasing the sun warm.

ADD TO THE PACKAGE FOR COVERAGE

QTY	ITEM	WHY
1 ea	6×6 + 8×8 **SOLID**	**The #1 add.** The current list has grid but no solid that size. You cannot do the subtract step without it.
1	Butterfly / overhead rig + 2 hi-rollers or boom	To fly the solid at 9–12 ft. Note the offset grows as the sun drops: 9.5 ft up-sun at 14:30, **26.6 ft at 16:30** — overheads get harder late, the opposite of side frames.
1 ea	4×4 hard silver + 4×4 soft silver	The only sources that compete with the sun, because they re-aim it. Setup C lives or dies on this.
2	4×4 solid / duvetyne (neg fill)	Subtracting is half of day exterior and the most under-packed item on most trucks.
1 kit	4×4 single + double nets	Knock a stop out of the key without changing its quality. Classic day-ext control.
1 kit	Flags, cutters, dots & fingers	Flare control at 90° side sun, and small cuts for instrument detail work.
—	**IRND set, 6–8 stops**	**Check this today.** At 8,735 fc, ISO 800, 1/50 you are at f/75. You need roughly 7.5 stops of ND to work at f/5.6 — 5.5 stops at ISO 200. Without it you cannot shoot at all.

LEVELS ARE ORDER-OF-MAGNITUDE FROM LUMINOUS FLUX AND INVERSE SQUARE — VERIFY AGAINST THE HEAD'S PHOTOMETRIC CHART AND A METER ON THE DAY.

VEGA BAJA SKATE PARK

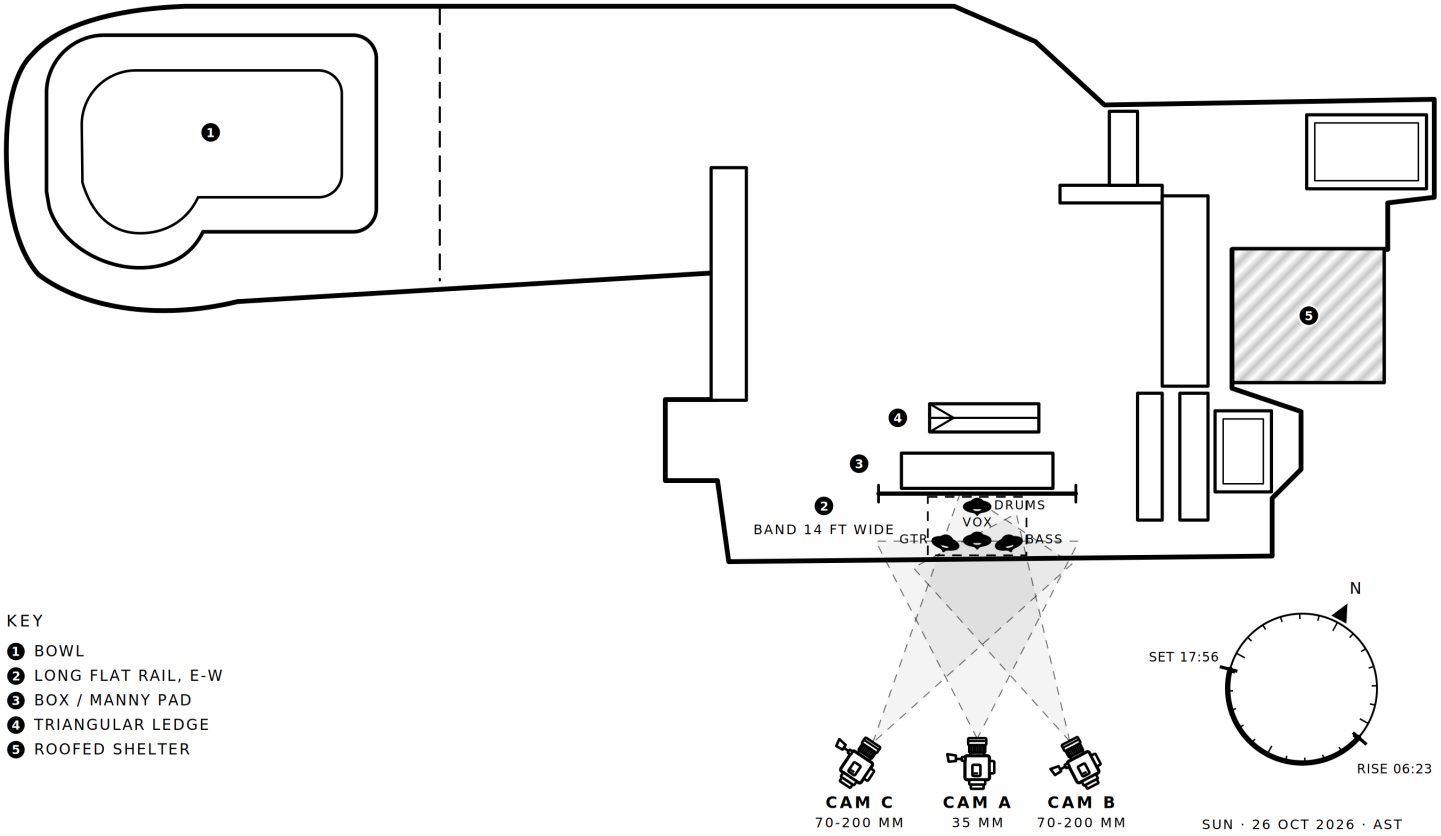
OVERHEAD LAYOUT BASE · PAGE UP = 332° (NNW)

CORRE FORREST! · SHOOT 26 OCT 2026

REV 6 · 16 OCT 2026

CAMERAS

A	35 MM	BAND WIDE / CENTRE
B	70-200 MM	CLOSE / VOCALS
C	70-200 MM	CLOSE / INSTRUMENTS



KEY

1. BOWL
2. LONG FLAT RAIL, E-W
3. BOX / MANNY PAD
4. TRIANGULAR LEDGE
5. ROOFED SHELTER

SUN · 26 OCT 2026 · AST

0 25 50 75 FEET

PAD 202.8 ft × 81.0 ft · SCALE FROM GOOGLE MAPS BAR